

TidyTuesday Week 36

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Wednesday 2nd September, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where we throw two economic time series into a blender, hit "regress," and pretend the result means something. This week the machine was feeling a little sleepy, which I frankly appreciate, because it means fewer opportunities to embarrass ourselves in front of the entire discipline of statistics.

First up, on August 31, we paired the thrilling "Percent of Value of Loans, SBA-Backed, Zero Interval, Moderate Risk" (a series so beloved it has a popularity score of 1, and was also, delightfully, discontinued) with house prices in Ft. Lauderdale. And the verdict? Nothing. The raw regression coughed up a p-value of 0.33, which in human terms means "please stop looking at me." The detrended version was equally unbothered. So here we have the rare case of two series that couldn't be induced to correlate even by our aggressively lenient standards. Refreshing, honestly. No trend mirage, no fake romance, just two strangers who made eye contact and immediately walked away.

September 2 is where it got briefly exciting, which is to say I sat up in my chair for approximately four seconds. We matched "Aggregate Weekly Hours in Durable Goods Manufacturing" against "Demand Deposits Due to Foreign Official Institutions" (also discontinued, because this project apparently only invites series that have already given up on life). The raw regression came in significant – p-value of 0.006, a real "ooh" moment – suggesting that as foreign officials parked money in banks, factory workers... clocked slightly fewer hours? A thrilling geopolitical thriller of a correlation. And then we detrended it, and the whole thing evaporated like a puddle in a Florida parking lot. P-value shot up to 0.82, R-squared plummeted to a heroic 0.0003. Classic. Both series just happened to drift over the decades, the raw regression mistook that shared drift for love, and detrending mercifully filed for annulment.

So the scoreboard this week: one big fat nothing and one textbook trend-mirage that fooled absolutely no one who bothered to look twice. As always, I remind you that these are randomly paired series with zero causal story, zero rigorous claim, and zero reason to exist beyond my own amusement. Spurious correlation isn't the bug here – it's the entire feature. See you next week, when the blender will inevitably find two discontinued series drifting upward together and try to convince us they're soulmates.

2 Date: 2026-08-31

Series ID: EBZMNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans, Small Business Administration (SBA) Backed for Zero Interval, Moderate Risk, All Commercial Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2012-07-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: ATNHPIUS22744Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Ft. Lauderdale-Pompano Beach-Sunrise, FL (MSAD) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1975-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 14.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS22744Q	R-squared:	0.054			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.001			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.023			
Date:	Mon, 31 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.325			
Time:	18:19:31	Log-Likelihood:	-95.885			
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	195.8			
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	197.8			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	228.2095	7.532	30.297	0.000	212.384	244.035
value_fred_EBZMNQ	-2.5123	2.484	-1.011	0.325	-7.732	2.707
Omnibus:	1.225	Durbin-Watson:	0.142			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.542	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.944			
Skew:	-0.262	Prob(JB):	0.624			
Kurtosis:	2.073	Cond. No.	3.38			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

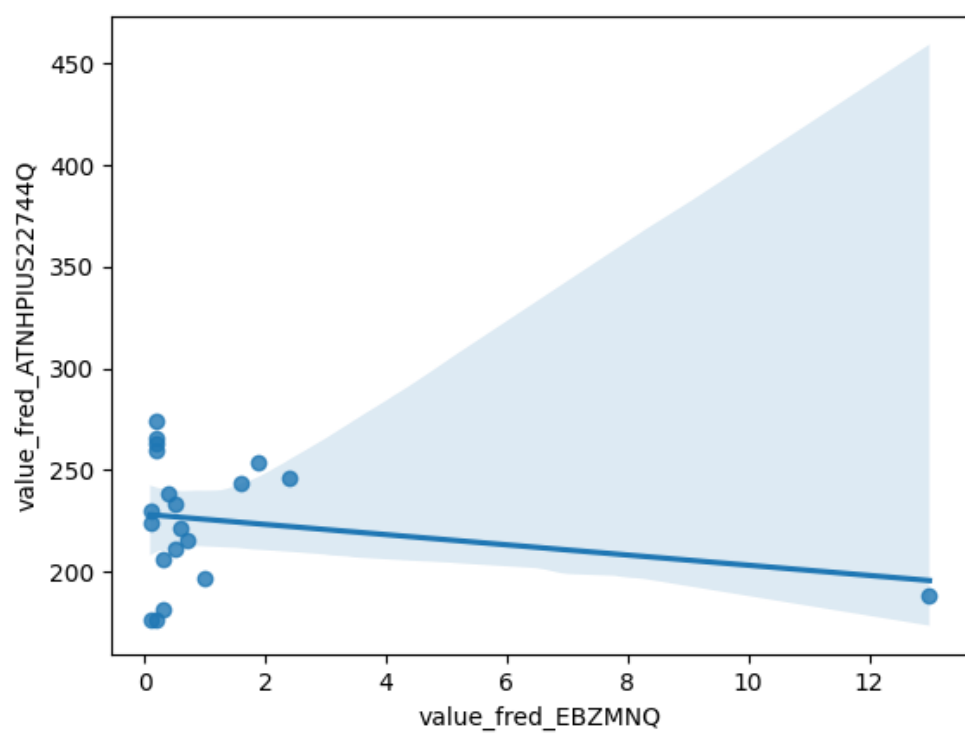


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-31

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS22744Q_detrended	R-squared:	0.096
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.045
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.904
Date:	Mon, 31 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.185
Time:	18:19:31	Log-Likelihood:	-47.327
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	98.65
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	100.6
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.994e-11	0.608	-3.28e-11	1.000	-1.277	1.277
value_fred_EBZMNQ_detrended	-0.3090	0.224	-1.380	0.185	-0.780	0.162

Omnibus:	1.101	Durbin-Watson:	0.883
Prob(Omnibus):	0.577	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.608
Skew:	-0.424	Prob(JB):	0.738
Kurtosis:	2.893	Cond. No.	2.71

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

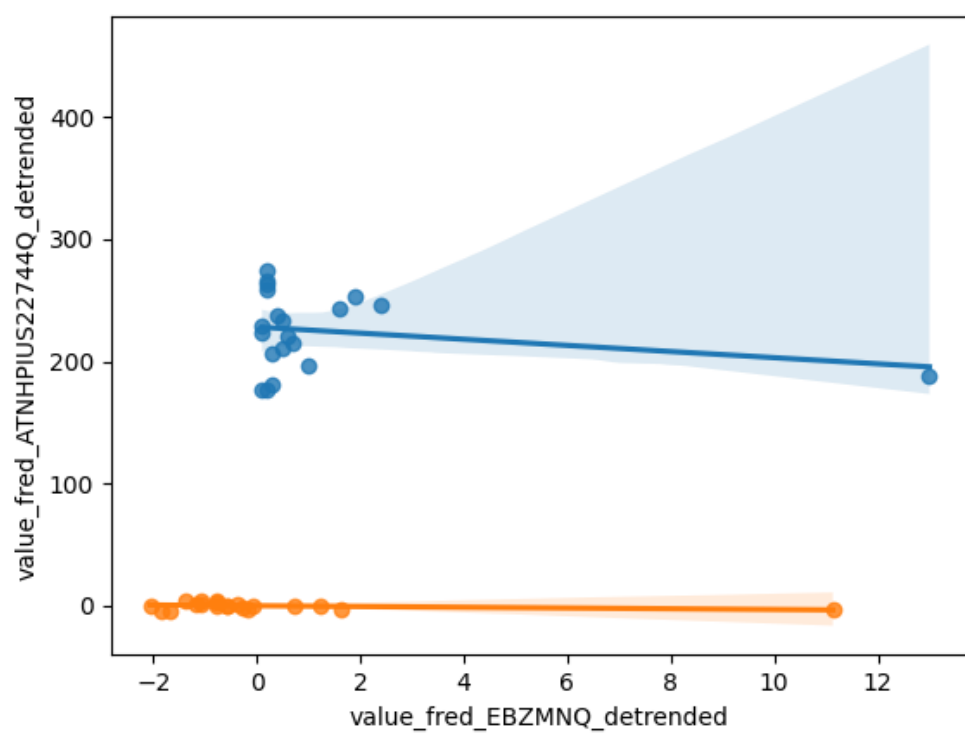


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-31

3 Date: 2026-09-02

Series ID: CEU3100000016

This series is titled Indexes of Aggregate Weekly Hours of All Employees, Durable Goods and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 2007=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2006-03-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: DDDFOINS

This series is titled Demand Deposits at Banks Due to Foreign Official Institutions (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1959-01-01 and the observation end date is 2021-01-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DDDFOINS	R-squared:	0.042			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.036			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	7.715			
Date:	Wed, 02 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00607			
Time:	15:25:54	Log-Likelihood:	-715.97			
No. Observations:	179	AIC:	1436.			
Df Residuals:	177	BIC:	1442.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	55.3897	14.155	3.913	0.000	27.455	83.325
value_fred_CEU3100000016	-0.4390	0.158	-2.778	0.006	-0.751	-0.127
Omnibus:	30.591	Durbin-Watson:	0.012			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	40.300			
Skew:	1.071	Prob(JB):	1.77e-09			
Kurtosis:	3.905	Cond. No.	1.28e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.28e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

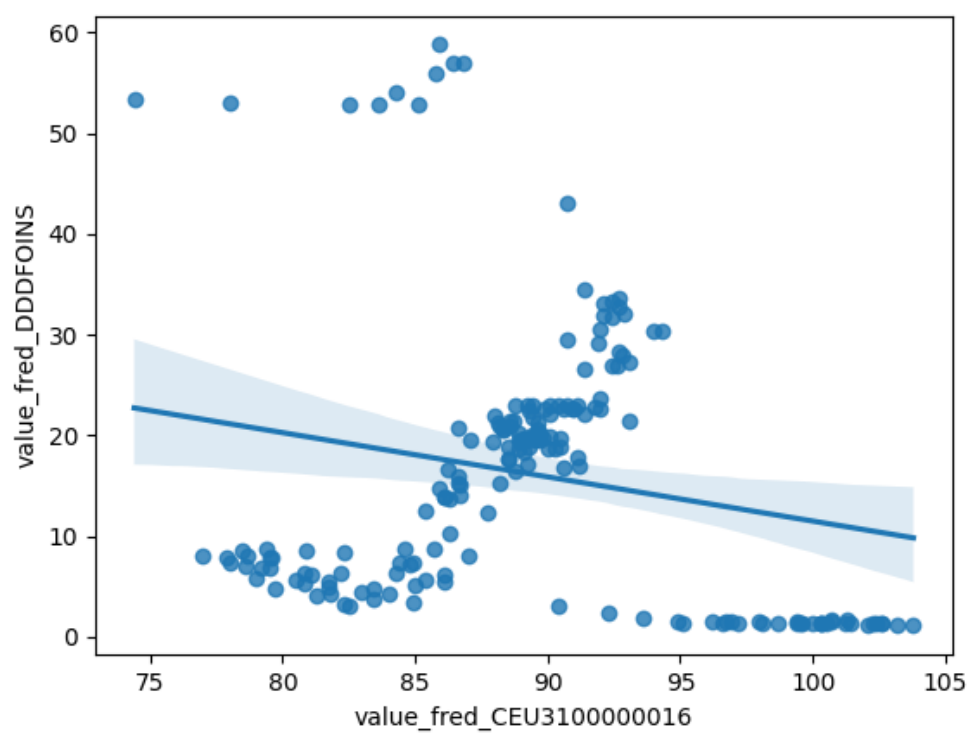


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-02

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DDDFOINS_detrended	R-squared:	0.000
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.005
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.05396
Date:	Wed, 02 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.817
Time:	15:25:54	Log-Likelihood:	-568.24
No. Observations:	179	AIC:	1140.
Df Residuals:	177	BIC:	1147.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.765e-14	0.435	-4.06e-14	1.000	-0.858	0.858
value_fred_CEU3100000016_detrended	-0.0165	0.071	-0.232	0.817	-0.157	0.124

Omnibus:	69.935	Durbin-Watson:	0.069
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	182.593
Skew:	1.695	Prob(JB):	2.24e-40
Kurtosis:	6.605	Cond. No.	6.13

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

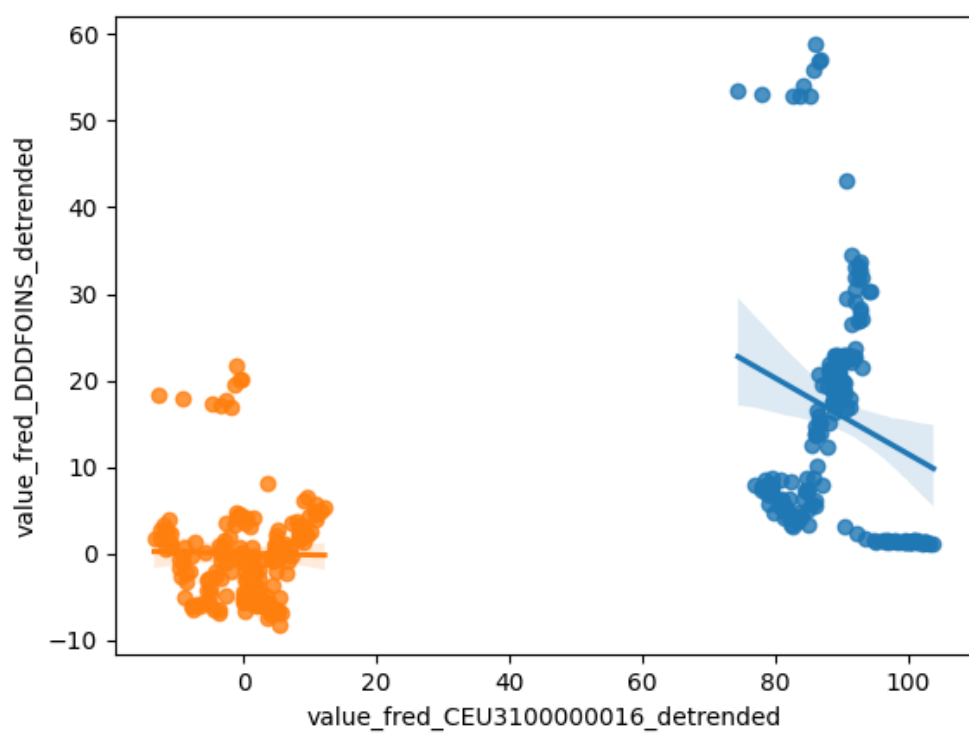


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-02